



# Technical Writing

## IV SEMESTER

### HS-204



# Technical Writing Course Objectives

- To improve grammar and sentence structure and build vocabulary.
- To understand how to write different types of writings.
- To understand how to compose different types of business documents
- To understand business ethics and develop soft skills



# Technical Writing Course Outcomes (CO)

- Ability to improve grammar and sentence structure and build vocabulary.
- Ability to write different types of writings with clarity.
- Ability to write different types of business documents.
- To understand business ethics and develop soft skills
- Ability to apply business ethics and enhance personality



# Technical Writing Course Outcomes (CO)

**Course Outcomes (CO to Programme Outcomes (PO) Mapping (scale 1: low, 2: Medium, 3: High**

| CO/PO | PO01 | PO02 | PO03 | PO04 | PO05 | PO06 | PO07 | PO08 | PO09 | PO10 | PO11 | PO12 |
|-------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
| CO1   | -    | -    | -    | -    | -    | 1    | -    | -    | -    | 3    | -    | -    |
| CO2   | -    | -    | -    | -    | -    | 1    | -    | -    | -    | 3    | -    | -    |
| CO3   | -    | -    | -    | -    | -    | 1    | -    | -    | -    | 3    | -    | -    |
| CO4   | -    | -    | -    | -    | -    | 1    | -    | 3    | -    | 3    | -    | -    |

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Subject: Technical Writing, Instructor: Dr. Sandeep Sharma



# UNIT 1

Grammar and Vocabulary--- Types of sentences (simple, complex and compound) and use of connectives in sentences, Subject-verb agreement, Comprehension, Synonyms and Antonyms, Homophones and Homonyms, Word Formation: Prefixes and Suffixes, Indianism, Misappropriation and Redundant Words, Question Tags and Short Responses.



## UNIT 2

Writing Styles -- Expository, Explanatory, Descriptive, Argumentative and Narrative. Precis writing, Visual Aids in Technical Writing, Plagiarism and Language Sensitivity in Technical Writing, Dialogue Writing, Proposals: Purpose and Types.



## UNIT 3

Letters at the Workplace—letter writing: Request, Sales, Enquiry, Order and Complaint. Job Application---Resume and Cover letter, Difference between Resume and CV, Preparation for Interview. Meeting Documentation--- Notice, Memorandum, Circular, Agenda, Office Order and Minutes of meeting, Writing Instructions.



## UNIT 4

Ethics and Personality Development    The Role of Ethics in Business    Communication—Ethical Principles, Time Management, Self-Analysis through SWOT and JOHARI Window, Emotional Intelligence and Leadership Skills, Team Building, Career Planning, Self Esteem



# Writing Styles -- Expository, Explanatory, Descriptive, Argumentative and Narrative.

An essay is a focused piece of writing designed to inform or persuade. There are many different types of essay, but they are often defined in four categories: argumentative, expository, narrative, and descriptive essays.

Argumentative and expository essays are focused on conveying information and making clear points, while narrative and descriptive essays are about exercising creativity and writing in an interesting way. At university level, argumentative essays are the most common type.



# Writing Styles -- Expository, Explanatory, Descriptive, Argumentative and Narrative.

| Essay type           | Skills tested                                                                                                                 | Example prompt                                                                                |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <u>Argumentative</u> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>•Forming an opinion via research</li><li>•Building an evidence-based argument</li></ul> | Has the rise of the internet had a positive or negative impact on education?                  |
| <u>Expository</u>    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>•Knowledge of a topic</li><li>•Communicating information clearly</li></ul>              | Explain how the invention of the printing press changed European society in the 15th century. |
| <u>Narrative</u>     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>•Creative language use</li><li>•Presenting a compelling narrative</li></ul>             | Write about an experience where you learned something about yourself.                         |
| <u>Descriptive</u>   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>•Creative language use</li><li>•Describing sensory details</li></ul>                    | Describe an object that has sentimental value for you.                                        |



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# Argumentative essays

An argumentative essay presents an extended, evidence-based argument. It requires a strong thesis statement—a clearly defined stance on your topic. Your aim is to convince the reader of your thesis using evidence (such as quotations) and analysis.

Argumentative essays test your ability to research and present your own position on a topic. This is the most common type of essay at college level—most papers you write will involve some kind of argumentation.

The essay is divided into an introduction, body, and conclusion:

- The introduction provides your topic and thesis statement
- The body presents your evidence and arguments
- The conclusion summarizes your argument and emphasizes its importance



# Expository essays

An expository essay provides a clear, focused explanation of a topic. It doesn't require an original argument, just a balanced and well-organized view of the topic.

Expository essays test your familiarity with a topic and your ability to organize and convey information. They are commonly assigned at high school or in exam questions at college level.

The introduction of an expository essay states your topic and provides some general background, the body presents the details, and the conclusion summarizes the information presented.



# Narrative essays

A narrative essay is one that tells a story. This is usually a story about a personal experience you had, but it may also be an imaginative exploration of something you have not experienced.

Narrative essays test your ability to build up a narrative in an engaging, well-structured way. They are much more personal and creative than other kinds of academic writing. Writing a personal statement for an application requires the same skills as a narrative essay.

A narrative essay isn't strictly divided into introduction, body, and conclusion, but it should still begin by setting up the narrative and finish by expressing the point of the story—what you learned from your experience, or why it made an impression on you.



# Descriptive essays

A descriptive essay provides a detailed sensory description of something. Like narrative essays, they allow you to be more creative than most academic writing, but they are more tightly focused than narrative essays. You might describe a specific place or object, rather than telling a whole story.

Descriptive essays test your ability to use language creatively, making striking word choices to convey a memorable picture of what you're describing.

A descriptive essay can be quite loosely structured, though it should usually begin by introducing the object of your description and end by drawing an overall picture of it. The important thing is to use careful word choices and figurative language to create an original description of your object.



# Precis writing

Precis writing is a summary or a gist of a comprehensive passage that is supposed to cover all the details and important aspects of the passage and convey the summary with the use of minimal words.

- **Rules of Precis Writing**

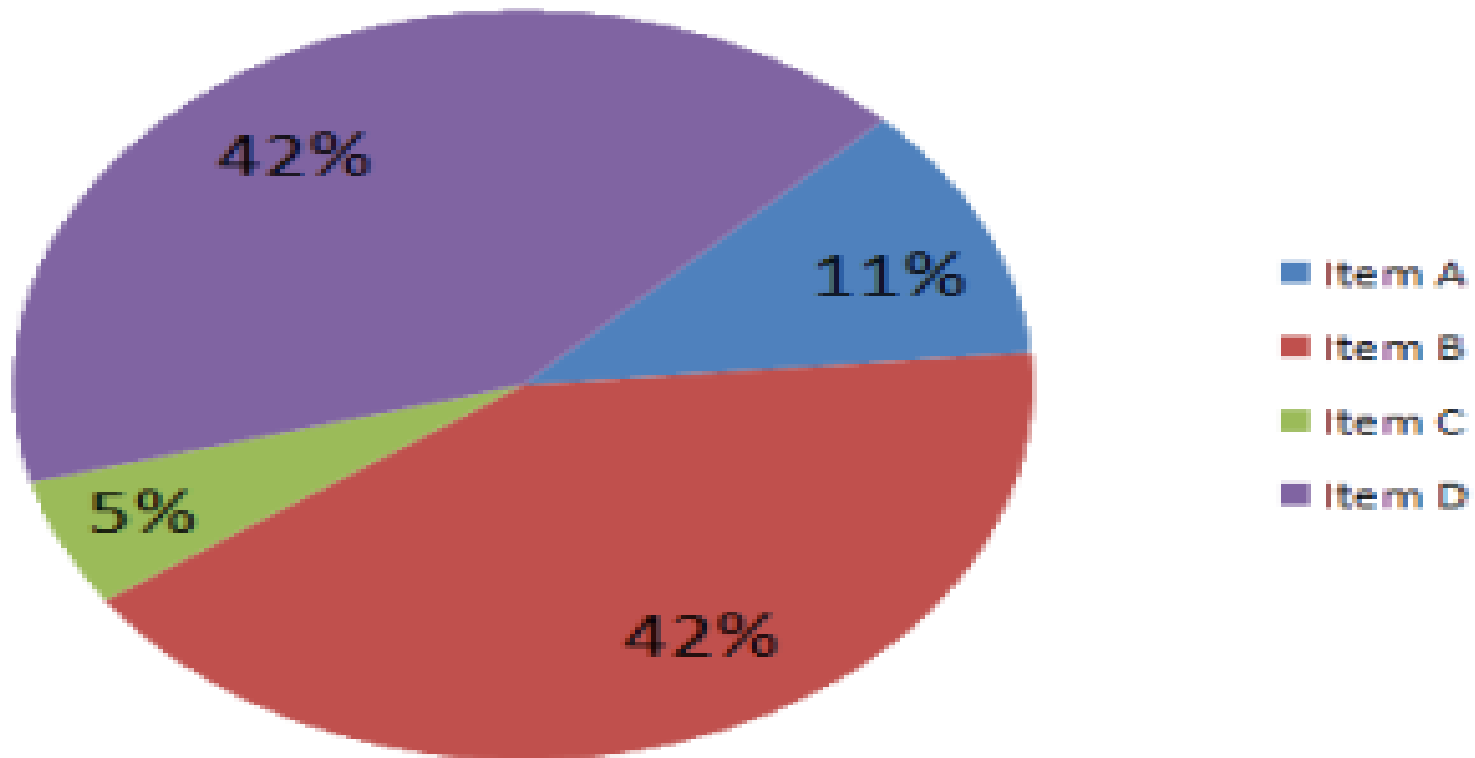
- To avoid making any errors in writing a precis, follow a set of rules as mentioned below:
- Read the comprehension carefully
- Note down the important points
- Make a rough draft of the precis
- Make use of simple and precise language, as much as possible
- Draft the final precis once all the points have been included



# Precis writing

- Discussed below are a few of the features which shall help you write a good precis:
- **Length of the Precis:** Do not write a lengthy precis. In most cases, the number of words must be almost one-third of the word count of the passage or comprehension.
- **It should be convenient to read:** Make sure that the precis you write does not have too complex a vocabulary or is too complicated to understand.
- **Cover all the essential points:** While reading the passage, make a note of the important points and ensure that no point is skipped.
- **Must be coherent:** The important terms with respect to the passage must be included in the precis as well.
- **Use an appropriate Title:** The precis needs to have a title. So, the candidates must ensure that the title is in sync with the comprehension.
- **Details in precis must match the details in the passage:** No other information apart from the one given in the passage must be included in the precis and all the important information mentioned in the passage must certainly be included.

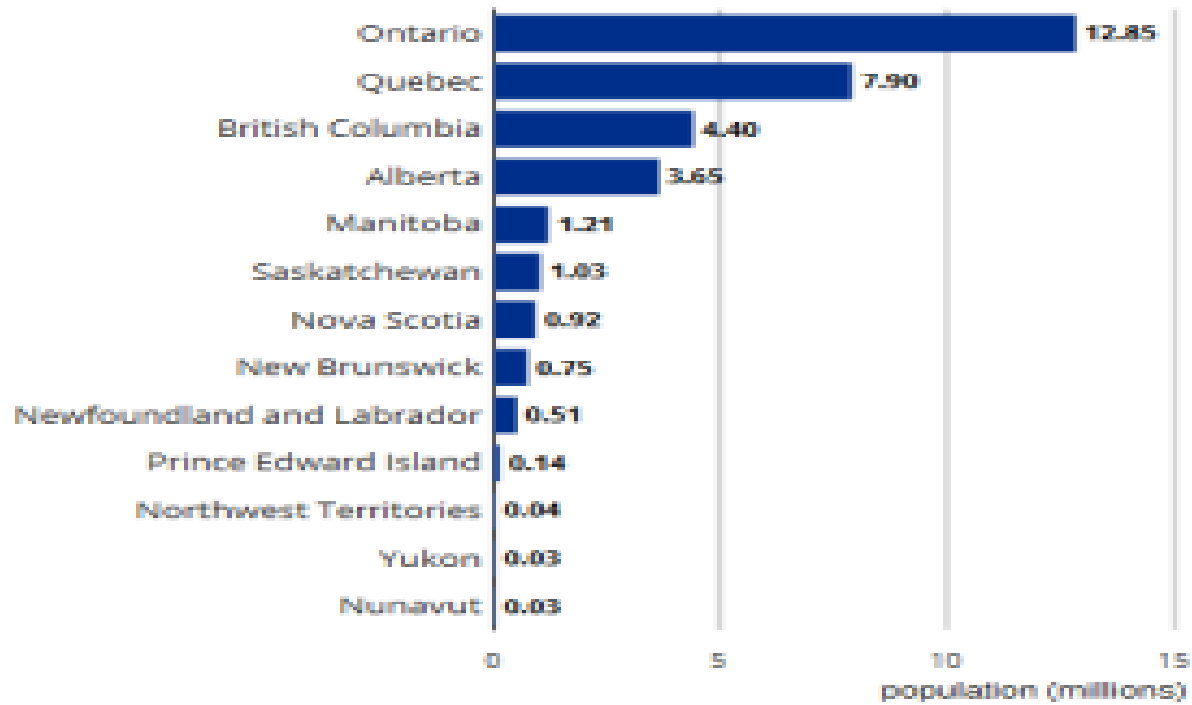
# Visual Aids in Technical Writing Pie chart



# Visual Aids in Technical Writing

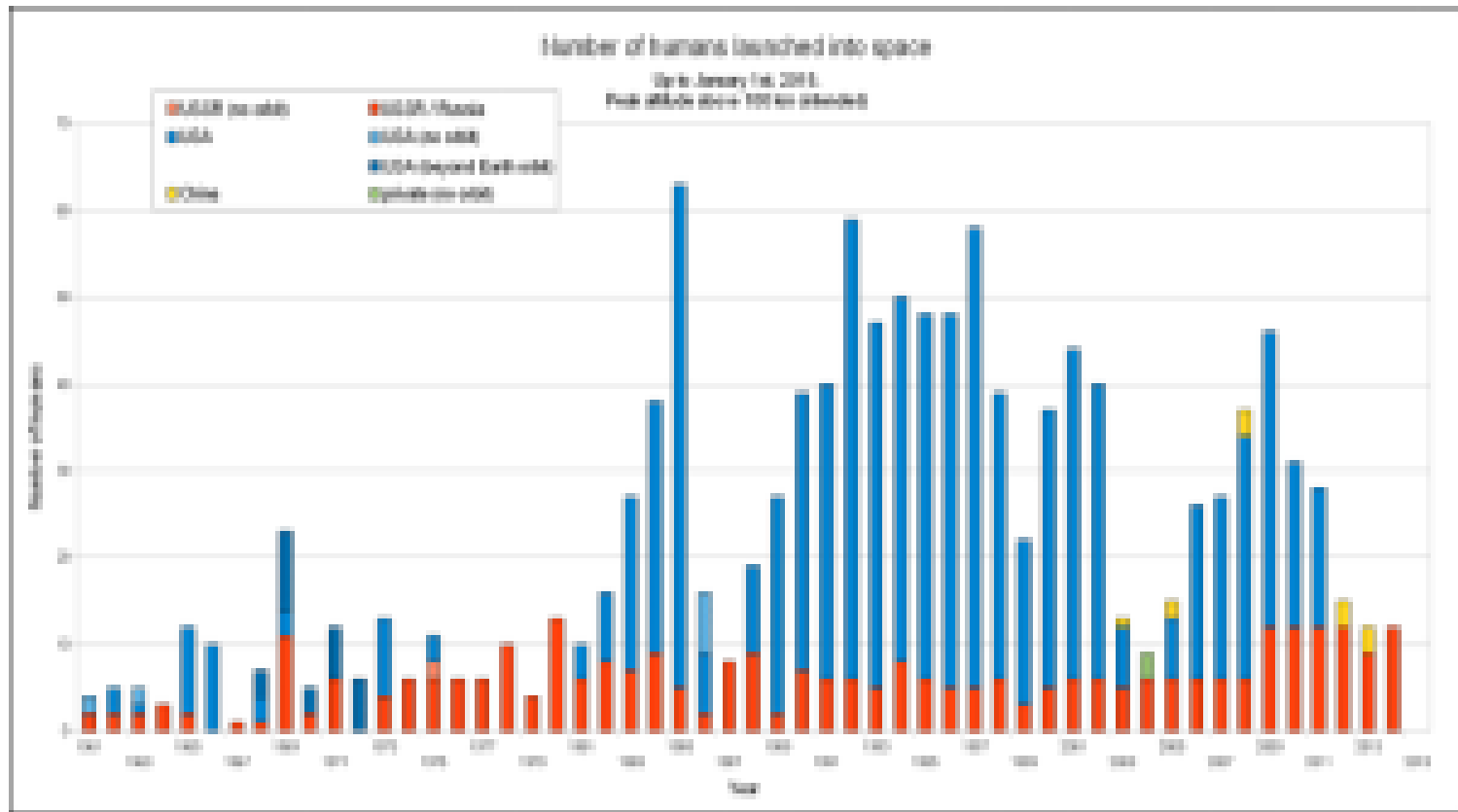
## Horizontal bar graph

**Population by Province/Territory**  
Canada, 2011 Census

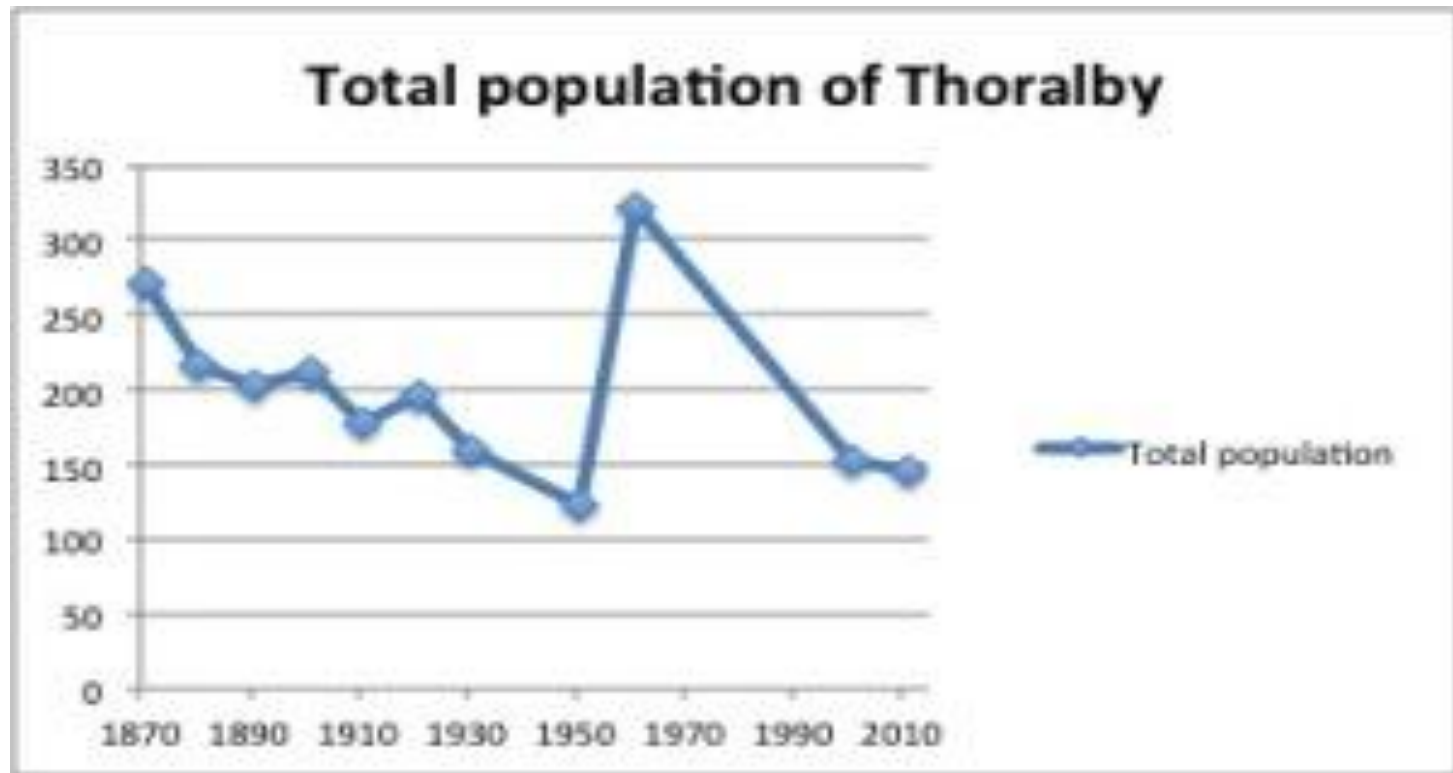


# Visual Aids in Technical Writing

## Vertical bar graph

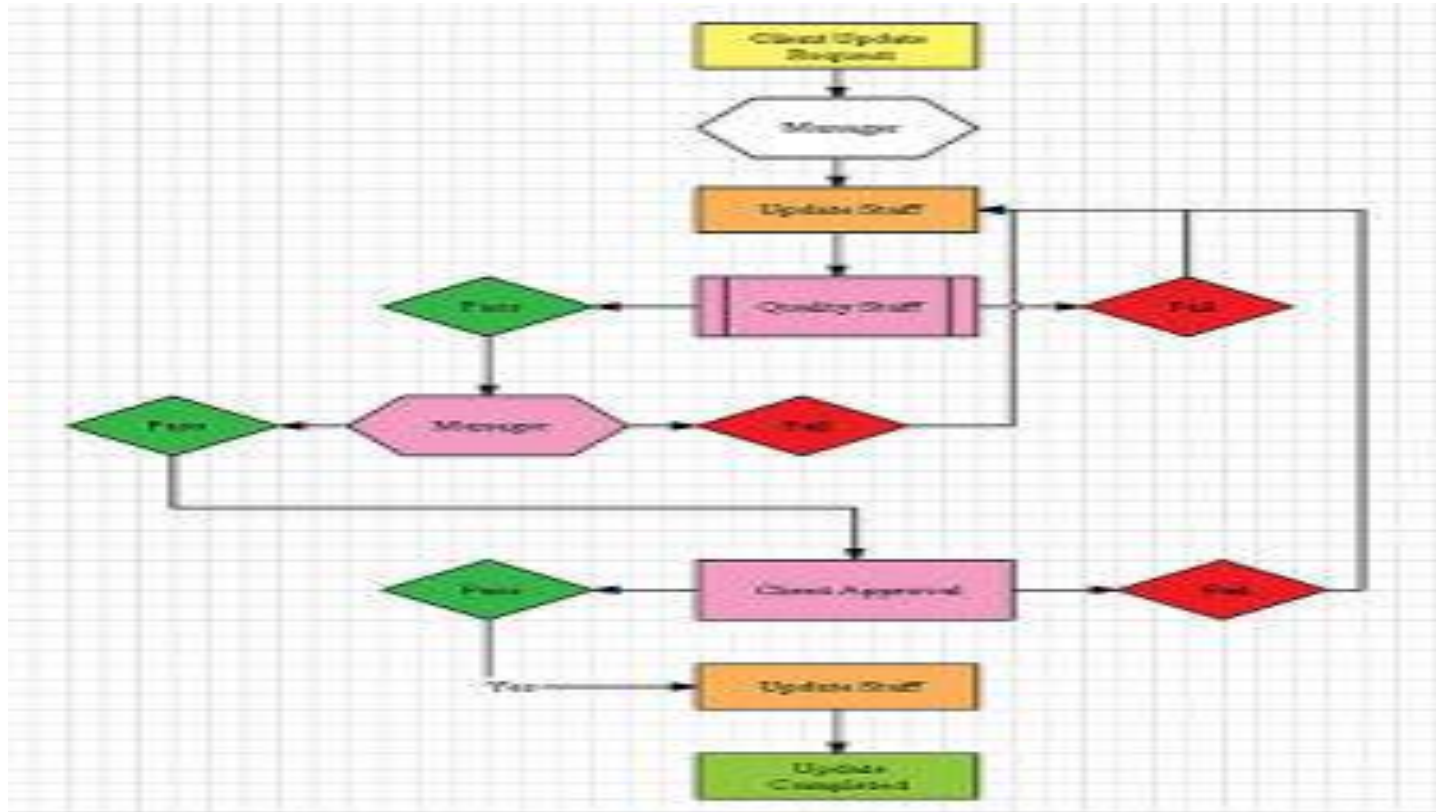


# Visual Aids in Technical Writing Line graph



# Visual Aids in Technical Writing

## Flowchart





# Plagiarism and Language Sensitivity in Technical Writing

Plagiarism is fairly easy to avoid as long as you pay close attention to how you integrate your source material and make sure that you give credit to the source when using someone else's words or ideas. There are two ways to use someone's ideas: you may use them **word for word (verbatim)** as a quote, or you may **paraphrase** the idea in your own words. Either way, the original author should be credited for their words or ideas.

Plagiarism (sometimes called "literary theft") is the presentation of someone else's work as your own.



# Plagiarism and Language Sensitivity in Technical Writing

Copying and pasting from a source into your work without attribution

Purchasing a paper online or from another student

Turning in the same work in two different classes (self-plagiarism)

Failing to put quotation marks around direct quotes in your work

Copying a diagram, image, graph, or photo into your work without referencing the source

Copying and pasting text and changing just a few words or phrases to “put it into your own words,” sometimes referred to as patch writing

Using information gained in a personal interview or conversation without citing the source

Failing to cite sources for any information that you used in your paper



# Plagiarism and Language Sensitivity in Technical Writing

To avoid the plagiarism trap, here are 8 simple rules each researcher should follow:

## **CITE WHILE YOU WRITE**

To avoid missing citations, make sure to insert citations while you are writing your paper. If you put your paper aside for a few days, you may forget where you found a particular piece of information or from where you copied a quote.

## **AVOID COPY-PASTING**

Avoid copy-pasting from other papers. It is better you reproduce someone else's idea in your own words (so called "paraphrasing") and provide a citation to the original source. Alternatively, if you specifically want to quote the original author, immediately insert the quotation marks around text you copy-pasted, followed by the citation.



# Plagiarism and Language Sensitivity in Technical Writing

## **USE SHORT QUOTATIONS**

Make sure you don't quote entire paragraphs. Limit quotations to one or two key sentences. Further, limit the total number of quotations in your paper to just a few. Lots of quotations make your text harder to read.

## **ASK FOR PERMISSION FROM THE COPYRIGHT HOLDER**

If you are copying small parts of a work, such as a short quote or a comment, and you are not sure if this falls under fair use, it is better to ask the copyright holder for a written permission.



# Plagiarism and Language Sensitivity in Technical Writing

## **COPYING IMAGES AND PHOTOS IS ALSO PLAGIARISM**

Images and photos (or videos) are also copyrighted. If you wish to re-use someone else's visuals in your own paper (for instance, in a review paper or in the methods section of a research paper), make sure you obtain written permission from the copyright holder. Many copyright holders will allow you to re-use given imagery if you properly cite and attribute the original source of the images, sometimes with a small fee. Follow the guidance of the copyright holder regarding the best wording to use for attribution.



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## **INFORM YOUR CO-AUTHORS**

You may be asked to work collaboratively in your class or workplace. If so, it's important to make sure that all your co-workers/collaborators are familiar with best practices to avoid plagiarism. If in doubt, have your paper checked by a plagiarism detection software before submitting.



# Plagiarism and Language Sensitivity in Technical Writing

## **APPLY THE SAME STANDARDS WHEN COPYING FROM OPEN ACCESS JOURNALS OR THE PUBLIC DOMAIN**

If you re-use images or photos from open access journals, make sure to include the citation. If you quote from works that are available under an open access license or in the public domain (such as quoting from an author that is long deceased), you still have to use quotation marks and use a proper citation. While it would not be a copyright infringement to reproduce a work that is considered public domain, some readers might still consider it deceitful if you do not properly attribute the original author/work.

## **AVOID SELF-PLAGIARISM**

If you re-use your own previous work or imagery in new papers, this often leads to self-plagiarism. Usually, you give up copyright when transferring your work to a publisher so that self-plagiarism often constitutes a copyright infringement. In addition to possible copyright infringement, it is not good practice to re-publish material that is already available elsewhere.



# Dialogue Writing

If you want to write a story, dialogues are a very important part of the story. Writing a good dialogue requires a set of rules to follow because a bad dialogue can change the story and the dialogue's meaning as well. Dialogue writing is a very important part of English writing.

Dialogue is basically a conversation between two or more people. In fiction, it is a verbal conversation between two or more conversations. Sometimes it is a self-talking dialogue, they are known as a Monolog.

If the dialogue is bad the reader will put the book down. Without effective dialogues, the whole plot of the story will collapse on its own structure. Therefore, writing dialogue in a way that attracts the reader to be more involved in the story is not a daunting task. We will guide you to write impactful dialogue with correct rules.



# Dialogue Writing

## Points to be Remember

1. The students need to read the preceding and the following dialogues.
2. They must understand the topic well and make points.
3. The tenses should be accurate according to the dialogue.
4. It should seem like a natural conversation.
5. The words used should not be vague and should convey the message.

## Tips to Write Dialogue

Speak out the Dialogue loudly as it will help you resonate on your own dialogue and make you understand how it will sound to the reader.

Keep your dialogue brief and impactful as adding extra details will only deviate the reader's mind from the main point.

Give each character a unique way of talking or voice. It will add an extra character trait and readers can identify the character just by reading his dialogue.

While writing the dialogue always remember whom the dialogue is being addressed to. Dialogues should not be lengthy and confusing for the readers as through the dialogue only the story moves.



# Dialogue Writing

## **Format of Dialogue Writing**

### **New Paragraph for Every Speaker**

Every speaker gets a new paragraph. Each time a speaker says something, you have to put in a fresh paragraph, even if it is just one word.

### **Punctuations Come under Quotation Marks**

All the punctuations used with dialogue must be put under the quotes.

### **Remove End Quote if the Paragraph is Long**

If the paragraph of dialogue is too long and you need to change the paragraph, then there is no need to put end quotes.



# Dialogue Writing

## Dialogue Tags

Dialogue tags i.e. He says/she says are always written outside the dialogue and is separated by a comma. When dialogue ends in a question or exclamation mark, tags that follow start in lower case.

For eg- He says, “We should start our own business.”

## Use Single Quotation Mark to Quote Something with a Dialogue

If you have to quote something within a dialogue we should put single quotes as double quotes are already enclosing the main dialogue.

For eg- Bill shouted, “‘boo!’ you lost the game.

## The Dialogue Ends with an Ellipsis

If the Dialogue ends with an ellipsis, we should not add a comma or any other punctuation. For eg- She stared at the sunset. “I guess you’ll go back to doing what you do and I will...” her voice drifted off.



# Dialogue Writing

**Write a Dialogue between You and Your Teacher about which Course to Study at Vacations.**

Child- Good Morning Sir, how are you?

Teacher- I am completely fine. What about you?

Student- I was wondering which course to learn in my vacation.

Teacher- It can be confusing with so many options online. You should make a list and narrow it down as per your interest.

Student- I have tried that but still I am left with three options- Artificial Intelligence, Machine learning or Data science.

Teacher- Well! All of them are very interesting courses, but as far as I remember you have always been interested in Artificial Intelligence.

Student- Yes! I do because I feel it is our future.

Teacher- Well then its no harm in pursuing it and later if you find it less interesting you can always switch.

Student- Yes it sounds like a great idea. Thanks!



# Proposals: Purpose and Types.

A proposal is a special type of professional report with two distinct purposes:

1. to persuade your reader to agree with your recommendations about how to address a problem or issue
2. to get your reader to act on your recommendations

## **Proposal Types**

Proposals may be internal or external, solicited or unsolicited.

### **Internal Proposals**

Internal proposals are written by and for someone within the same organization. Since both the writer and reader share the same workplace context, these proposals usually address some way to improve a work-related situation (productivity, efficiency, profit, etc.).

### **External Proposals**

External proposals are sent outside of the writer's organization to a separate entity (often to solicit business, or to respond to another organization's request for proposals). Since these are external documents, they are usually formal in nature and may be introduced by a letter of transmittal.



# Proposals: Purpose and Types.

## Solicited Proposals

You may write a solicited proposal if an organization identifies a situation it wants to improve or a problem that it wants to solve. A department or an organization may issue a request for proposals (RFP), asking for proposals on how to address the situation or issue. The requesting department or organization will evaluate proposals and choose the most convincing one, often using a detailed scoring rubric or weighted objectives to determine which proposal best responds to the request and addresses the organization's needs.

## Unsolicited Proposals

You may initiate a proposal yourself if you see a problem or an opportunity to make a beneficial change. With unsolicited proposals within an organization, you need to identify your audience very carefully in order to get your ideas to the right audience, either an individual or group with decision-making responsibility, or a supervisor who can support the proposal and move it to a higher decision-making level. Always consider your organization's environment, internal politics, and how your proposal potentially may be received. For unsolicited proposals outside of your organization, make sure that you clearly create a need for your audience to convince that audience to read and respond. Unsolicited external proposals are often the most difficult kind of proposal to get approved.



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